# Alterf Widget - Install Guide

Tile-style Conky desktop widget for Linux Mint / Ubuntu - github.com/White-fang10/Alterf-widget

The widget shows a greeting, date, weather, Wi-Fi name, RAM and CPU rings, storage, network speed and the song currently playing, each in its own rounded glass tile. Installing takes about 10 minutes and works with a single git clone.

## Step 1: Install the required packages

Open a terminal and run:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install conky-all jq curl playerctl git
```

> **Use conky-all, not conky.** The plain package often lacks Lua and cairo support, which this widget needs to draw the tiles.

## Step 2: Download the widget from GitHub

Clone the repository straight into your Conky folder:

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/conky
git clone https://github.com/White-fang10/Alterf-widget.git ~/.config/conky/Alterf
```

> If you get *destination path already exists*, you already have an Alterf folder. Move it away first: `mv ~/.config/conky/Alterf ~/.config/conky/Alterf-old`, then run the clone command again.

## Step 3: Install the fonts

```
mkdir -p ~/.fonts
cp -r ~/.config/conky/Alterf/fonts/* ~/.fonts/
fc-cache -f
```

The widget also uses the **Inter** font. If text looks different, install it with `sudo apt install fonts-inter`.

## Step 4: Set your own profile picture

Replace the avatar with your own square PNG (about 200x200 or larger), keeping the same name:

```
cp ~/Pictures/me.png ~/.config/conky/Alterf/res/ava.png
```

## Step 5: Set your city for the weather

Open the weather script in any text editor:

```
xed ~/.config/conky/Alterf/scripts/weather-v2.0.sh
```

Find the line that sets the city or location (look for words like city, location, lat, lon or q=) and change it to your own. If the script asks for an API key (for example from openweathermap.org), put your own free key there. A new key can take a little while to start working.

> Until this is set, the widget may show the original author's city (Copenhagen).

## Step 6: Start the widget

```
killall conky
conky -c ~/.config/conky/Alterf/Alterf.conf
```

Leave the terminal open for the first test so any errors are visible. If it looks right, continue to step 7.

## Step 7: Start it automatically at login

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/autostart
cat > ~/.config/autostart/conky-alterf.desktop << 'EOF'
[Desktop Entry]
Type=Application
Name=Conky Alterf
Exec=sh -c "sleep 10 && conky -c $HOME/.config/conky/Alterf/Alterf.conf"
X-GNOME-Autostart-enabled=true
EOF
```

The 10 second delay lets the desktop and network start first, so weather and Wi-Fi show correctly.

> **Only use one launcher.** If you also use Conky Manager, turn off its startup option and untick the widgets in it. Two launchers can start an old copy and override this one.

## Updating later

To get new changes from the repository:

```
cd ~/.config/conky/Alterf
git stash
git pull
git stash pop
```

The `stash` lines keep your own changes (avatar, city) safe while updating. Conky reloads by itself when files change.

## Troubleshooting

| Problem | Fix |
|---|---|
| No tiles, plain text only | Run conky in a terminal and read the error. Usually conky-all is missing or card.lua is in the wrong folder. |
| Avatar or weather icon missing | Check ~/.config/conky/Alterf/res/ava.png exists. Weather icon needs a working weather script. |
| Wrong city / no weather | Edit weather-v2.0.sh (step 6) and check that jq and curl are installed. |

| Problem | Fix |
| --- | --- |
| git clone says folder exists | An Alterf folder is already there. Rename it (mv ~/.config/conky/Alterf ~/.config/conky/Alterf-old) and clone again. |
| Widget returns to old look | Another launcher is starting an old copy. Run: ps aux \| grep [c]onky and check the path. |
| Wrong position or size | Change gap_x and gap_y at the top of Alterf.conf. |
| Tiles too dark or too clear | Change TILE_ALPHA near the top of scripts/card.lua (0.80 by default). |
| No song shown | Install playerctl. Not every player reports its song title. |

## Customizing

Colors are in the palette block at the top of `scripts/card.lua` (PINK, GREEN, WHITE, GREY, DARK). Each value is red, green and blue between 0 and 1. Conky reloads automatically when you save the file.